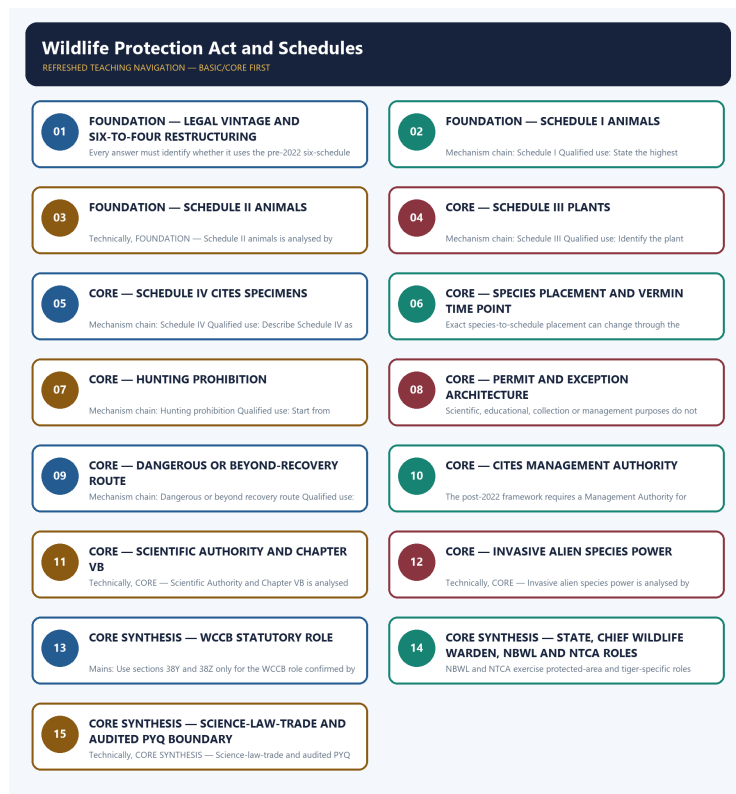


COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

Wildlife Protection Act and Schedules - Learner-v2 Refreshed

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / SESSION INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Wildlife Protection Act and Schedules - Learner-v2 Complete Learning Session

Authoring-only generation: 2026-09-03. No PDF was rendered and no tracker or index was mutated.

SOURCE, PROGRESSION AND CURRENT-LINKAGE AUDIT

- **Generation date:** 2026-09-03.
- **Repository-first evidence:** the Basic owner is taught first and preserved in full; the Advanced owner is retained only in the optional final teaching block.
- **OCR evidence:** Repository Markdown was primary. OCR-searchable local official General Studies papers were used only to confirm printed routed demands. No answer key, marking scheme, unsupported page precision, ecological rate, species count or current status was inferred.
- **Qdrant:** not used; repository Markdown and available OCR context were sufficient.
- **PYQ integrity:** Audited ledgers route the 2020 old Schedule VI plant demand, 2022 protected-animal provisions and 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin framing. They remain answer-free objective demands. The package fixes the legal time point and does not infer a species placement, penalty, notification or option key.
- **Live-link boundary:** India Code returned HTTP 403 on 2026-09-03. Official state forest department copies of the 2022 amendment were retrievable only as raw or image PDF bytes and were not text-mined. MoEFCC's wildlife page was used narrowly for WCCB sections 38Y and 38Z; its stale or erroneous material was excluded. No species schedule, penalty or later amendment was inferred.
- **Fact/inference discipline:** no current-affairs item, PYQ wording, figure or quotation is invented.

LIVE OFFICIAL-SOURCE ATTEMPT LOG

The checks below were made on 2026-09-03. Substantive official text is used only for the proposition it supports. Stubs, access failures, unrelated pages and thin landing pages are recorded and are not converted into ecological or current-status claims.

- https://www.indiacode.nic.in/indiacode/handle/123456789/12931?view_type=browse - attempted 2026-09-03; India Code returned HTTP 403, so no schedule placement, penalty or provision was imported.
- <https://hpforest.gov.in/storage/files/1/Acts/Wild%20Life%20Act%20%202022%20New%20amendments.pdf> - attempted 2026-09-03; an official state forest department copy of the 2022 amendment was retrievable only as raw PDF bytes, so it was logged but not text-mined.
- [https://www.forests.tn.gov.in/frontend/gos/The_Wild_Life_\(Protection\)_Amendment_Act,_2022_123.pdf](https://www.forests.tn.gov.in/frontend/gos/The_Wild_Life_(Protection)_Amendment_Act,_2022_123.pdf) - attempted 2026-09-03; the official state forest department PDF was image/raw-byte content, so no section, schedule or penalty was transcribed.
- <https://moef.gov.in/wildlife> - attempted 2026-09-03; substantive MoEFCC text expressly linked WCCB to sections 38Y and 38Z. The page also contained visibly stale or erroneous material, so no species count, reserve count, penalty or schedule placement was taken from it.
- <https://moef.gov.in/wildlife-wl> - attempted 2026-09-03; substantive MoEFCC text confirmed the Wildlife Division's legal-policy role and the four protected-area categories. It was not used to infer a species schedule or a current legal amendment.

BASIC LEARNING SESSION



Refreshed teaching navigation

Distinct embedded teaching-navigation image. The separate continuous Cārvāka-style flowchart package remains an independent at-a-glance artifact.

SESSION 1 - FOUNDATION - LEGAL VINTAGE AND SIX-TO-FOUR RESTRUCTURING

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Mechanism chain: Legal vintage first - Six schedules to four Qualified use: Open by fixing the pre- or post-2022 legal structure.

Technical definition: Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Mechanism chain: Legal vintage first - Six schedules to four Qualified use: Open by fixing the pre- or post-2022 legal structure.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **FOUNDATION**
- **Legal vintage**
- **six-to-four restructuring**
- **Mechanism chain**
- **Qualified use**
- **Protection Act. The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022**

How to use them: Frame the answer through FOUNDATION; define Legal vintage, connect six-to-four restructuring with Mechanism chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

LEGAL VINTAGE AND SIX-TO-FOUR RESTRUCTURING

01. Legal vintage first

|
v

02. Six schedules to four

BOUNDARY -> Do not answer a pre-2022 question with the post-2022 schedule count without qualification.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act. The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act.
- The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not answer a pre-2022 question with the post-2022 schedule count without qualification.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact ecological level, system boundary, stock or flow, pyramid parameter, succession substrate, biome scale, taxonomic term and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Open by fixing the pre- or post-2022 legal structure.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Legal vintage first -> Six schedules to four
- **Qualified use:** Open by fixing the pre- or post-2022 legal structure.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FOUNDATION - LEGAL VINTAGE AND SIX-TO-FOUR RESTRUCTURING

START / CONCEPT: FOUNDATION - Legal vintage and six-to-four restructuring

|
v

EXACT TERMS: FOUNDATION · Legal vintage · six-to-four restructuring · Mechanism chain · Qualified use · Protection Act. The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Do not answer a pre-2022 question with the post-2022 schedule count without qualification.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: legal vintage first - Six schedules to four Qualified use.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Mechanism chain: Legal vintage first - Six schedules to four Qualified use: Open by fixing the pre- or post-2022 legal structure.

SESSION 2 - FOUNDATION - SCHEDULE I ANIMALS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule.

Technical definition: Mechanism chain: Schedule I Qualified use: State the highest animal-protection schedule without guessing species placement.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- FOUNDATION
- Schedule I animals
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- Under
- Schedule

How to use them: Frame the answer through FOUNDATION; define Schedule I animals, connect Mechanism chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Under for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

SCHEDULE I ANIMALS

01. Schedule I

BOUNDARY -> Do not say the current Act still has six schedules.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not say the current Act still has six schedules.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact ecological level, system boundary, stock or flow, pyramid parameter, succession substrate, biome scale, taxonomic term and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** State the highest animal-protection schedule without guessing species placement.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Schedule I
- **Qualified use:** State the highest animal-protection schedule without guessing species placement.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FOUNDATION - SCHEDULE I ANIMALS

START / CONCEPT: FOUNDATION - Schedule I animals

|

v

EXACT TERMS: FOUNDATION • Schedule I animals • Mechanism chain • Qualified use • Under • Schedule

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: Schedule I Qualified use: State the highest animal-protection schedule without guessing species placement.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Do not say the current Act still has six schedules.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: do not say the current Act still has six schedules.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule.

SESSION 3 - FOUNDATION - SCHEDULE II ANIMALS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Mechanism chain: Schedule II Qualified use: Contrast Schedule II with Schedule I while retaining legal protection.

Technical definition: Technically, FOUNDATION - Schedule II animals is analysed by relating FOUNDATION to Schedule II animals, then testing the relationship through Mechanism chain and Qualified use.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Mechanism chain: Schedule II Qualified use: Contrast Schedule II with Schedule I while retaining legal protection.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- FOUNDATION
- Schedule II animals
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- Schedule
- Schedule II Qualified

How to use them: Frame the answer through FOUNDATION; define Schedule II animals, connect Mechanism chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Schedule for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

SCHEDULE II ANIMALS

01. Schedule II

BOUNDARY -> Do not assign a species to Schedule I from memory without checking the current text.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not assign a species to Schedule I from memory without checking the current text.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact ecological level, system boundary, stock or flow, pyramid parameter, succession substrate, biome scale, taxonomic term and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Contrast Schedule II with Schedule I while retaining legal protection.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Schedule II
- **Qualified use:** Contrast Schedule II with Schedule I while retaining legal protection.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FOUNDATION - SCHEDULE II ANIMALS

START / CONCEPT: FOUNDATION - Schedule II animals

|

v

EXACT TERMS: FOUNDATION · Schedule II animals · Mechanism chain · Qualified use · Schedule · Schedule II Qualified

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Do not assign a species to Schedule I from memory without checking the current text.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The resulting consequence is that contrast Schedule II with Schedule I while retaining legal protection.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: contrast Schedule II with Schedule I while retaining legal protection.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Mechanism chain: Schedule II Qualified use: Contrast Schedule II with Schedule I while retaining legal protection.

SESSION 4 - CORE - SCHEDULE III PLANTS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI.

Technical definition: Mechanism chain: Schedule III Qualified use: Identify the plant schedule and its old Schedule VI lineage.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Schedule III plants**
- **Mechanism chain**
- **Qualified use**
- **Post-2022 Schedule III**
- **Post**
- **Schedule III**

How to use them: Frame the answer through Schedule III plants; define Mechanism chain, connect Qualified use with Post-2022 Schedule III to explain the mechanism, and use Post for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

SCHEDULE III PLANTS

01. Schedule III

BOUNDARY -> Do not describe Schedule II as unprotected wildlife.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not describe Schedule II as unprotected wildlife.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact ecological level, system boundary, stock or flow, pyramid parameter, succession substrate, biome scale, taxonomic term and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Identify the plant schedule and its old Schedule VI lineage.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Schedule III
- **Qualified use:** Identify the plant schedule and its old Schedule VI lineage.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - SCHEDULE III PLANTS

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Schedule III plants

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Schedule III plants • Mechanism chain • Qualified use • Post-2022 Schedule III • Post
• Schedule III

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: Schedule III Qualified use: Identify the plant schedule and its old Schedule VI lineage.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Do not describe Schedule II as unprotected wildlife.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI.

SESSION 5 - CORE - SCHEDULE IV CITES SPECIMENS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II.

Technical definition: Mechanism chain: Schedule IV Qualified use: Describe Schedule IV as trade regulation, not a protection rung.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Schedule IV CITES specimens**
- **Mechanism chain**
- **Qualified use**
- **Post**
- **Schedule IV**
- **CITES-listed**

How to use them: Frame the answer through Schedule IV CITES specimens; define Mechanism chain, connect Qualified use with Post to explain the mechanism, and use Schedule IV for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

SCHEDULE IV CITES SPECIMENS

01. Schedule IV

BOUNDARY -> Do not call post-2022 Schedule III an animal-protection tier.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not call post-2022 Schedule III an animal-protection tier.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact ecological level, system boundary, stock or flow, pyramid parameter, succession substrate, biome scale, taxonomic term and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Describe Schedule IV as trade regulation, not a protection rung.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Schedule IV
- **Qualified use:** Describe Schedule IV as trade regulation, not a protection rung.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - SCHEDULE IV CITES SPECIMENS

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Schedule IV CITES specimens

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Schedule IV CITES specimens · Mechanism chain · Qualified use · Post · Schedule IV · CITES-listed

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: Schedule IV Qualified use: Describe Schedule IV as trade regulation, not a protection rung.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Do not call post-2022 Schedule III an animal-protection tier.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II.

SESSION 6 - CORE - SPECIES PLACEMENT AND VERMIN TIME POINT

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Mechanism chain: Species placement discipline - Vermin time point Qualified use: Verify current notification and treat vermin through the correct legal vintage.

Technical definition: Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Mechanism chain: Species placement discipline - Vermin time point Qualified use: Verify current notification and treat vermin through the correct legal vintage.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Species placement
- vermin time point
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- Exact
- Schedule

How to use them: Frame the answer through Species placement; define vermin time point, connect Mechanism chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Exact for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

SPECIES PLACEMENT AND VERMIN TIME POINT

01. Species placement discipline

|
v

02. Vermin time point

BOUNDARY -> Do not call Schedule IV the highest domestic protection category.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification. The old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022; the owner records a central notification route for a specified area and period and excludes Schedule I animals.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification.
- The old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022; the owner records a central notification route for a specified area and period and excludes Schedule I animals.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not call Schedule IV the highest domestic protection category.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact ecological level, system boundary, stock or flow, pyramid parameter, succession substrate, biome scale, taxonomic term and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Verify current notification and treat vermin through the correct legal vintage.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Species placement discipline -> Vermin time point
- **Qualified use:** Verify current notification and treat vermin through the correct legal vintage.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - SPECIES PLACEMENT AND VERMIN TIME POINT

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Species placement and vermin time point

|
v

EXACT TERMS: Species placement • vermin time point • Mechanism chain • Qualified use • Exact • Schedule

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Do not call Schedule IV the highest domestic protection category.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: the old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Mechanism chain: Species placement discipline - Vermin time point
Qualified use: Verify current notification and treat vermin through the correct legal vintage.

SESSION 7 - CORE - HUNTING PROHIBITION

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission.

Technical definition: Mechanism chain: Hunting prohibition Qualified use: Start from prohibition rather than exception.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Hunting prohibition
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- The Act's baseline
- The Act's
- CITES Appendix

How to use them: Frame the answer through Hunting prohibition; define Mechanism chain, connect Qualified use with The Act's baseline to explain the mechanism, and use The Act's for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

HUNTING PROHIBITION

01. Hunting prohibition

BOUNDARY -> Do not treat CITES Appendix change as an instantaneous Indian schedule amendment.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not treat CITES Appendix change as an instantaneous Indian schedule amendment.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact ecological level, system boundary, stock or flow, pyramid parameter, succession substrate, biome scale, taxonomic term and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Start from prohibition rather than exception.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Hunting prohibition
- **Qualified use:** Start from prohibition rather than exception.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - HUNTING PROHIBITION

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Hunting prohibition

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Hunting prohibition · Mechanism chain · Qualified use · The Act's baseline · The Act's
· CITES Appendix

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: Hunting prohibition Qualified use: Start from prohibition
rather than exception.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Do not treat CITES Appendix change as an instantaneous Indian schedule
amendment.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: start from prohibition rather than
exception.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a
legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission.

SESSION 8 - CORE - PERMIT AND EXCEPTION ARCHITECTURE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Mechanism chain: Permit and exception Qualified use: Name the purpose, permit,
authority and statutory condition.

Technical definition: Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right
to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable
permit and statutory conditions remain necessary.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Permit
- exception architecture
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- Scientific
- Schedule

How to use them: Frame the answer through Permit; define exception architecture, connect Mechanism chain with
Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Scientific for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

PERMIT AND EXCEPTION ARCHITECTURE

01. Permit and exception

BOUNDARY -> Do not say the old Schedule V vermin list still exists.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not say the old Schedule V vermin list still exists.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact ecological level, system boundary, stock or flow, pyramid parameter, succession substrate, biome scale, taxonomic term and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Name the purpose, permit, authority and statutory condition.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Permit and exception
- **Qualified use:** Name the purpose, permit, authority and statutory condition.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - PERMIT AND EXCEPTION ARCHITECTURE

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Permit and exception architecture

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Permit · exception architecture · Mechanism chain · Qualified use · Scientific · Schedule

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: Permit and exception Qualified use: Name the purpose, permit, authority and statutory condition.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Do not say the old Schedule V vermin list still exists.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary.

SESSION 9 - CORE - DANGEROUS OR BEYOND-RECOVERY ROUTE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision.

Technical definition: Mechanism chain: Dangerous or beyond recovery route Qualified use: Use the narrow condition without converting it into a general culling power.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Dangerous or beyond-recovery route**
- **Mechanism chain**
- **Qualified use**
- **The owner records narrow action where an animal**
- **Dangerous**
- **Qualified**

How to use them: Frame the answer through Dangerous or beyond-recovery route; define Mechanism chain, connect Qualified use with The owner records narrow action where an animal to explain the mechanism, and use Dangerous for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

DANGEROUS OR BEYOND-RECOVERY ROUTE

01. Dangerous or beyond recovery route

BOUNDARY -> Do not convert a hunting exception into a general permission.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not convert a hunting exception into a general permission.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact ecological level, system boundary, stock or flow, pyramid parameter, succession substrate, biome scale, taxonomic term and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Use the narrow condition without converting it into a general culling power.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Dangerous or beyond recovery route
- **Qualified use:** Use the narrow condition without converting it into a general culling power.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - DANGEROUS OR BEYOND-RECOVERY ROUTE

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Dangerous or beyond-recovery route

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Dangerous or beyond-recovery route • Mechanism chain • Qualified use • The owner records narrow action where an animal • Dangerous • Qualified

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: Dangerous or beyond recovery route Qualified use: Use the narrow condition without converting it into a general culling power.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Do not convert a hunting exception into a general permission.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: use the narrow condition without converting it into a general culling power.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision.

SESSION 10 - CORE - CITES MANAGEMENT AUTHORITY

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Mechanism chain: CITES Management Authority Qualified use: Assign permits and certificates to the Management Authority.

Technical definition: The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Mechanism chain: CITES Management Authority Qualified use: Assign permits and certificates to the Management Authority.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- CITES Management Authority
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- Management Authority
- CITES Management Authority Qualified
- Assign

How to use them: Frame the answer through CITES Management Authority; define Mechanism chain, connect Qualified use with Management Authority to explain the mechanism, and use CITES Management Authority Qualified for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

CITES MANAGEMENT AUTHORITY

01. CITES Management Authority

BOUNDARY -> Do not omit the competent authority and written-permission requirement.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not omit the competent authority and written-permission requirement.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact ecological level, system boundary, stock or flow, pyramid parameter, succession substrate, biome scale, taxonomic term and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Assign permits and certificates to the Management Authority.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** CITES Management Authority
- **Qualified use:** Assign permits and certificates to the Management Authority.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - CITES MANAGEMENT AUTHORITY

START / CONCEPT: CORE - CITES Management Authority

|
v

EXACT TERMS: CITES Management Authority · Mechanism chain · Qualified use · Management Authority ·
CITES Management Authority Qualified · Assign

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and
certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Do not omit the competent authority and written-permission requirement.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: assign permits and certificates to
the Management Authority.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Mechanism chain: CITES Management Authority Qualified use: Assign
permits and certificates to the Management Authority.

SESSION 11 - CORE - SCIENTIFIC AUTHORITY AND CHAPTER VB

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Mechanism chain: CITES Scientific Authority - Chapter VB trade architecture Qualified use: Separate scientific advice from Chapter VB's wider trade machinery.

Technical definition: Technically, CORE - Scientific Authority and Chapter VB is analysed by relating Scientific Authority to Chapter VB, then testing the relationship through Mechanism chain and Qualified use.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Mechanism chain: CITES Scientific Authority - Chapter VB trade architecture Qualified use: Separate scientific advice from Chapter VB's wider trade machinery.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Scientific Authority
- Chapter VB
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- Management Authority
- CITES Scientific Authority

How to use them: Frame the answer through Scientific Authority; define Chapter VB, connect Mechanism chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Management Authority for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

SCIENTIFIC AUTHORITY AND CHAPTER VB

01. CITES Scientific Authority

|
v

02. Chapter VB trade architecture

BOUNDARY -> Do not merge Management Authority and Scientific Authority functions.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The Scientific Authority advises on the conservation consequences of trade; it performs a different function from the permit-issuing Management Authority. The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The Scientific Authority advises on the conservation consequences of trade; it performs a different function from the permit-issuing Management Authority.
- The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not merge Management Authority and Scientific Authority functions.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact ecological level, system boundary, stock or flow, pyramid parameter, succession substrate, biome scale, taxonomic term and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Separate scientific advice from Chapter VB's wider trade machinery.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** CITES Scientific Authority -> Chapter VB trade architecture
- **Qualified use:** Separate scientific advice from Chapter VB's wider trade machinery.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - SCIENTIFIC AUTHORITY AND CHAPTER VB

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Scientific Authority and Chapter VB

|
v

EXACT TERMS: Scientific Authority · Chapter VB · Mechanism chain · Qualified use · Management Authority · CITES Scientific Authority

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Do not merge Management Authority and Scientific Authority functions.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The resulting consequence is that CITES Scientific Authority - Chapter VB trade architecture Qualified use.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: CITES Scientific Authority - Chapter VB trade architecture Qualified use.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Mechanism chain: CITES Scientific Authority - Chapter VB trade architecture Qualified use: Separate scientific advice from Chapter VB's wider trade machinery.

SESSION 12 - CORE - INVASIVE ALIEN SPECIES POWER

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Mechanism chain: Invasive alien species Qualified use: State the Central Government power without inventing a listed species.

Technical definition: Technically, CORE - Invasive alien species power is analysed by relating Invasive alien species power to Mechanism chain, then testing the relationship through Qualified use and WCCB.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Mechanism chain: Invasive alien species Qualified use: State the Central Government power without inventing a listed species.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Invasive alien species power
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- WCCB
- Invasive
- Qualified

How to use them: Frame the answer through Invasive alien species power; define Mechanism chain, connect Qualified use with WCCB to explain the mechanism, and use Invasive for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

INVASIVE ALIEN SPECIES POWER

01. Invasive alien species

BOUNDARY -> Do not use WCCB as the authority for every wildlife-law decision.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The amendment empowered the Central Government to regulate or prohibit the import, trade, possession or proliferation of invasive alien species under the applicable provision.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The amendment empowered the Central Government to regulate or prohibit the import, trade, possession or proliferation of invasive alien species under the applicable provision.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not use WCCB as the authority for every wildlife-law decision.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact ecological level, system boundary, stock or flow, pyramid parameter, succession substrate, biome scale, taxonomic term and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** State the Central Government power without inventing a listed species.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Invasive alien species
- **Qualified use:** State the Central Government power without inventing a listed species.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - INVASIVE ALIEN SPECIES POWER

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Invasive alien species power

|
v

EXACT TERMS: Invasive alien species power • Mechanism chain • Qualified use • WCCB • Invasive • Qualified

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Do not use WCCB as the authority for every wildlife-law decision.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The resulting consequence is that state the Central Government power without inventing a listed species.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: state the Central Government power without inventing a listed species.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Mechanism chain: Invasive alien species Qualified use: State the Central Government power without inventing a listed species.

SESSION 13 - CORE SYNTHESIS - WCCB STATUTORY ROLE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Mechanism chain: WCCB statutory role Qualified use: Use sections 38Y and 38Z only for the WCCB role confirmed by MoEFCC.

Technical definition: Mains: Use sections 38Y and 38Z only for the WCCB role confirmed by MoEFCC.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Mechanism chain: WCCB statutory role Qualified use: Use sections 38Y and 38Z only for the WCCB role confirmed by MoEFCC.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- CORE SYNTHESIS
- WCCB statutory role
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- MoEFCC's
- WCCB

How to use them: Frame the answer through CORE SYNTHESIS; define WCCB statutory role, connect Mechanism chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use MoEFCC's for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

WCCB STATUTORY ROLE

01. WCCB statutory role

BOUNDARY -> Do not attach a penalty amount without the applicable amendment and offence provision.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

MoEFCC's retrievable page states that WCCB was constituted under section 38Y and lists section 38Z functions including intelligence, coordination, capacity and international cooperation.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- MoEFCC's retrievable page states that WCCB was constituted under section 38Y and lists section 38Z functions including intelligence, coordination, capacity and international cooperation.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not attach a penalty amount without the applicable amendment and offence provision.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact ecological level, system boundary, stock or flow, pyramid parameter, succession substrate, biome scale, taxonomic term and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Use sections 38Y and 38Z only for the WCCB role confirmed by MoEFCC.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** WCCB statutory role
- **Qualified use:** Use sections 38Y and 38Z only for the WCCB role confirmed by MoEFCC.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE SYNTHESIS - WCCB STATUTORY ROLE

START / CONCEPT: CORE SYNTHESIS - WCCB statutory role

|
v

EXACT TERMS: CORE SYNTHESIS · WCCB statutory role · Mechanism chain · Qualified use · MoEFCC's · WCCB

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mains: Use sections 38Y and 38Z only for the WCCB role confirmed by MoEFCC.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Do not attach a penalty amount without the applicable amendment and offence provision.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: MoEFCC's retrievable page states that WCCB was constituted under section 38Y and lists section...

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Mechanism chain: WCCB statutory role Qualified use: Use sections 38Y and 38Z only for the WCCB role confirmed by MoEFCC.

SESSION 14 - CORE SYNTHESIS - STATE, CHIEF WILDLIFE WARDEN, NBWL AND NTCA ROLES

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Mechanism chain: State and Chief Wildlife Warden - NBWL and NTCA Qualified use: Map each domestic authority to its own jurisdiction.

Technical definition: NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- CORE SYNTHESIS
- Chief Wildlife Warden
- NBWL
- NTCA roles
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use

How to use them: Frame the answer through CORE SYNTHESIS; define Chief Wildlife Warden, connect NBWL with NTCA roles to explain the mechanism, and use Mechanism chain for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

STATE, CHIEF WILDLIFE WARDEN, NBWL AND NTCA ROLES

01. State and Chief Wildlife Warden

|

v

02. NBWL and NTCA

BOUNDARY -> Do not equate an IUCN category, domestic schedule and CITES Appendix.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB. NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB.
- NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not equate an IUCN category, domestic schedule and CITES Appendix.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact ecological level, system boundary, stock or flow, pyramid parameter, succession substrate, biome scale, taxonomic term and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Map each domestic authority to its own jurisdiction.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** State and Chief Wildlife Warden -> NBWL and NTCA
- **Qualified use:** Map each domestic authority to its own jurisdiction.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE SYNTHESIS - STATE, CHIEF WILDLIFE WARDEN, NBWL AND NTCA ROLES

START / CONCEPT: CORE SYNTHESIS - State, Chief Wildlife Warden, NBWL and NTCA roles

|
v

EXACT TERMS: CORE SYNTHESIS · Chief Wildlife Warden · NBWL · NTCA roles · Mechanism chain · Qualified use

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: State and Chief Wildlife Warden - NBWL and NTCA Qualified use: Map each domestic authority to its own jurisdiction.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not equate an IUCN category, domestic schedule and CITES Appendix.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities.

SESSION 15 - CORE SYNTHESIS - SCIENCE-LAW-TRADE AND AUDITED PYQ BOUNDARY

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Mechanism chain: Science, law and trade - Audited PYQ vintage boundary Qualified use: Close by separating IUCN science, domestic law, CITES trade and PYQ vintage.

Technical definition: Technically, CORE SYNTHESIS - Science-law-trade and audited PYQ boundary is analysed by relating CORE SYNTHESIS to Science-law-trade, then testing the relationship through audited PYQ boundary and Mechanism chain.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Mechanism chain: Science, law and trade - Audited PYQ vintage boundary Qualified use: Close by separating IUCN science, domestic law, CITES trade and PYQ vintage.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- CORE SYNTHESIS
- Science-law-trade
- audited PYQ boundary
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- Subject

How to use them: Frame the answer through CORE SYNTHESIS; define Science-law-trade, connect audited PYQ boundary with Mechanism chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

SCIENCE-LAW-TRADE AND AUDITED PYQ BOUNDARY

01. Science, law and trade

|
v

02. Audited PYQ vintage boundary

BOUNDARY -> Do not infer an objective answer key from a routed PYQ demand.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct. Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct.
- Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not infer an objective answer key from a routed PYQ demand.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact ecological level, system boundary, stock or flow, pyramid parameter, succession substrate, biome scale, taxonomic term and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Close by separating IUCN science, domestic law, CITES trade and PYQ vintage.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Science, law and trade -> Audited PYQ vintage boundary
- **Qualified use:** Close by separating IUCN science, domestic law, CITES trade and PYQ vintage.

COMPLETE BASIC OWNER EVIDENCE BANK

Subject: Environment and Ecology | **Tier:** Must-Do (foundation) | **GS Paper:** GS-III (Environment) + Prelims, with GS-II legal/governance linkage. **Core area:** Domestic wildlife law architecture. **Grounded in:** Wildlife Protection Act, 1972, as amended by the Wildlife (Protection) Amendment Act, 2022 (India Code); MoEFCC notifications; audited UPSC Environment PYQs (2024-2026 Prelims and 2024-2025 Mains). **FACT:** = source-grounded | **ANALYSIS:** = analytical linkage | **CURRENT:** = dated current-affairs anchor. **Companion:** advanced/08_Wildlife-Protection-Act-and-Schedules.md.

1. Visual foundation

WILDLIFE PROTECTION ACT, 1972 (AS AMENDED 2022) - SCHEDULE STRUCTURE

Schedule I -> ANIMALS given the greatest degree of protection; most severe penalties

Schedule II -> ANIMALS given a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I

Schedule III -> PLANTS (specified plant species protected under the Act)

Schedule IV -> SCHEDULED SPECIMENS: species listed in CITES Appendices I, II and III (the trade-regulation schedule, not a protection tier)

PRE-2022 STRUCTURE HAD SIX SCHEDULES (I-VI). THE 2022 AMENDMENT REDUCED THEM TO FOUR:

- the old Schedule V ("vermin") schedule was OMITTED altogether;
- plants moved from the old Schedule VI to the new Schedule III;
- a brand-new CITES-mirroring Schedule IV was created, with Chapter VB inserted to regulate international trade in scheduled specimens.

Core proposition: The Wildlife Protection Act, 1972 is India's core domestic species- protection statute, using a graded Schedule system to set differentiated penalties and protections; the 2022 amendment specifically restructured the Schedules to align India's domestic law with its CITES international-trade obligations.

2. Essential definitions

Concept	Exam-ready meaning
FACT: Wildlife Protection Act, 1972	India's principal law for protection of wild animals, birds and plants, and for regulating hunting and trade.
FACT: Schedule	A graded list within the Act assigning a species a specific protection level and penalty regime.
FACT: Schedule I	Animals given the greatest degree of protection under the Act, with the most stringent penalties for offences.
FACT: Schedule II	Animals given a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I.
FACT: Schedule III (post-2022)	Plants - the specified plant species protected under the Act (this was Schedule VI before the 2022 amendment).
FACT: Schedule IV (post-2022)	Scheduled specimens - species listed in CITES Appendices I, II and III, directly linking domestic law to international trade regulation. It is a <i>trade</i> schedule, not a higher protection tier.
FACT: Vermin	A wild animal declared, for a specified area and period, to be vermin so that it may be hunted. ANALYSIS: The old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022; the power now operates through a central-government notification, and a Schedule I animal can never be declared vermin.
FACT: Poaching	Illegal hunting/killing/capturing of protected wildlife under the Act.
FACT: Wildlife Crime Control Bureau (WCCB)	Statutory multi-disciplinary body under MoEFCC combating organised wildlife crime, including trafficking.

3. Topic mechanism

1. The Act empowers the central and state governments to declare protected areas, regulate hunting, and control trade in wild animals, parts and derivatives, backed by a graded Schedule classification assigning each species a specific protection tier.
2. Higher Schedules carry more stringent penalties and near-total prohibition on hunting. Hunting is permitted only in narrow statutory situations - chiefly where an animal has become **dangerous to human life, or is disabled or diseased beyond recovery**, with the permission of the **Chief Wildlife Warden** (for a Schedule I animal) or of an authorised officer, and for specified scientific/education/collection purposes under permit.
3. The Wildlife (Protection) Amendment Act, 2022 restructured the earlier six-schedule system into four schedules - animals (I and II), plants (III) and CITES-listed scheduled specimens (IV) - and **omitted the old vermin schedule**, meaning a change in a species' international CITES Appendix listing can now be reflected more directly in Indian domestic law.
4. The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated chapter on the ****regulation of international trade in scheduled specimens, requiring the central government to designate a Management Authority (permits and certificates) and a Scientific Authority**** (advice on trade impact) - the exact institutional design CITES requires of every party (Topic 09).
5. The 2022 amendment also empowered the central government to regulate or prohibit the **import, trade, possession or proliferation of invasive alien species**, strengthened penalties, and provided for management plans for sanctuaries and national parks.
6. Enforcement runs through state forest/wildlife departments for on-ground action and through the Wildlife Crime Control Bureau (WCCB) for organised, cross-border wildlife crime and intelligence coordination.

4. Institutions and policy tools

- FACT: **MoEFCC**: administers the Act and notifies Schedule amendments.
- FACT: **Wildlife Crime Control Bureau (WCCB)**: statutory body coordinating action against organised wildlife crime, including trafficking networks and international smuggling.
- FACT: **National Tiger Conservation Authority (NTCA)**: statutory authority under the Act for tiger conservation (cross-refer Topic 06).
- FACT: **National Board for Wildlife (NBWL) / State Boards for Wildlife**: advisory/approving bodies on wildlife-related matters, including projects affecting protected areas.

5. Indian applications and examples

- ANALYSIS: Species such as the tiger and elephant hold Schedule I status, reflecting the highest protection level and driving the strictest enforcement priority.
- ANALYSIS: The 2022 amendment's alignment of Schedule IV with CITES Appendices directly affects how India regulates international trade in listed plants and animals (cross-refer Topic 09).
- ANALYSIS: Invasive alien species provisions introduced in 2022 give the central government explicit authority to regulate species like certain introduced flora/fauna that threaten native ecosystems.

6. Must-Know Facts for Prelims

- FACT: The Wildlife Protection Act, 1972 is India's principal wildlife-protection statute.
- FACT: Schedule I provides the highest/most stringent protection level under the Act.
- FACT: The Wildlife (Protection) Amendment Act, 2022 restructured the earlier six-schedule system into four schedules.
- FACT: Post-2022 mapping to memorise: **Schedule I and II = animals** (greater and lesser protection), **Schedule III = plants**, **Schedule IV = CITES-listed scheduled specimens**. The old **Schedule V (vermin) was omitted**.
- FACT: The 2022 amendment requires the Centre to designate a **Management Authority** and a **Scientific Authority** for CITES implementation, and empowers it to regulate **invasive alien species**.
- FACT: Hunting is permissible only in narrow statutory circumstances - notably where an animal is **dangerous to human life or disabled/diseased beyond recovery** - and, for Schedule I animals, only on the written permission of the **Chief Wildlife Warden**.
- FACT: The Wildlife Crime Control Bureau (WCCB) is the statutory body coordinating action against organised wildlife crime in India.

7. UPSC traps

- WRONG: The Wildlife Protection Act still has six schedules today. -> The 2022 amendment restructured it into four schedules.
- WRONG: Schedule IV (post-2022) is India's highest protection category. -> Schedule I remains the highest protection category; Schedule IV specifically mirrors CITES Appendices for trade-regulation alignment.
- WRONG: CITES itself is enforced directly in India without domestic legislation. -> CITES obligations are given domestic legal effect through instruments like the Wildlife Protection Act's Schedule IV structure.
- WRONG: WCCB is a state-level body. -> It is a central, statutory, multi-disciplinary body under MoEFCC.
- WRONG: The Wildlife Protection Act only covers animals. -> It also covers specified plants, which after 2022 are listed in **Schedule III**.
- WRONG: Post-2022 Schedule III is a third tier of animal protection. -> Schedule III is the **plant** schedule; only Schedules I and II grade animal protection.

- **WRONG:** The vermin schedule still exists. -> The old Schedule V was **omitted** in 2022; vermin declaration now proceeds by central notification for a specified area and period, and can never apply to a Schedule I animal.
- **WRONG:** Schedule IV listing gives a species higher protection than Schedule II. -> Schedule IV is a **trade-control** schedule mirroring CITES Appendices, not a rung on the protection ladder.

8. CURRENT: Current anchor

- **CURRENT:** The Wildlife (Protection) Amendment Act, 2022 remains the current governing legal text; verify any further amendment or Schedule notification against the latest MoEFCC gazette notification before citing an updated Schedule list in an answer.

ANALYSIS: Interpretation caution: exact species-to-Schedule mappings are subject to periodic notification updates - cite the amendment year (2022) as the structural reference point rather than assuming a static, unchanging species list.

9. PYQ application

- **ANALYSIS:** Recurring Prelims pattern: identify the correct number of schedules post-2022 and match the CITES-alignment feature to Schedule IV specifically.
- **ANALYSIS:** Mains linkage: the domestic-law-to-international-obligation alignment (Schedule IV/ CITES) is used to argue for coherent, enforceable wildlife-trade governance.

10. Mains angles

- **ANALYSIS:** Argue that aligning domestic Schedules with CITES Appendices strengthens India's enforcement credibility in international wildlife-trade cooperation.
- **ANALYSIS:** Use the invasive-alien-species provision to argue for proactive, not just reactive, wildlife governance.
- **ANALYSIS:** Conclude with an enforcement-capacity thesis: legal restructuring (2022 amendment) is necessary but insufficient without adequately resourced WCCB and state-level enforcement.

Answer thesis: Treat the 2022-restructured Schedule system as India's mechanism for aligning domestic wildlife protection with international CITES obligations, and judge its real effectiveness by enforcement capacity (WCCB, state departments), not by the elegance of the legal restructuring alone.

11. Probable questions

- **ANALYSIS: Prelims:** State the number and structure of Schedules under the Wildlife Protection Act after the 2022 amendment and their relationship to CITES.
- **ANALYSIS: Mains (10 marks):** Explain how the Wildlife (Protection) Amendment Act, 2022 aligned India's domestic wildlife law with its CITES obligations.
- **ANALYSIS: Mains (15 marks):** Discuss the significance of empowering the central government to regulate invasive alien species under the 2022 amendment.

12. Study links

- **FACT:** Advanced companion: [advanced/08_Wildlife-Protection-Act-and-Schedules.md](#).
- **FACT:** [09_CITES-and-Wildlife-Trade.md](#) - the international treaty this Schedule IV structure now mirrors.
- **FACT:** [06_Protected-Area-Network-India.md](#) - the protected-area provisions of the same Act.
- **FACT:** [27_Environmental-Institutions-MoEFCC-CPCB-NBA-WII.md](#) - WCCB and NTCA institutional detail.

Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

Status: 2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2024-2025.md. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2024-2025 Prelims Set-A keys are present in the repository and CSAT Set-A keys are supplied; even so, no option or answer is recorded or inferred in this integration.

- **Years represented:** 2024
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2024	Prelims GS-I	20	Indian Flying Fox 'vermin' category under the Wild Life (Protection) Act, 1972	Objective question; official Set-A key available locally, answer not inferred	Key available locally (official Set-A answer key present); answer not recorded here	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Indian Flying Fox 'vermin' category under the Wild Life (Protection) Act, 1972

This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

13. Core answer architecture (10/15/20-mark support)

13.1 Demand decoder and thesis

- State the legal time point first: **pre-2022 six-schedule structure** versus **post-2022 four-schedule structure**. Then separate domestic protection from CITES trade control.
- **Thesis:** the 2022 reform is a domestic enforcement and treaty-alignment mechanism whose effectiveness still depends on notification, forensics and state-level enforcement.

13.2 Reusable evidence units

Claim	Named evidence/example -> significance	Qualification
The schedules have distinct functions.	Schedules I-II animals; III plants; IV CITES scheduled specimens -> Schedule IV is a trade-control alignment, not a higher conservation rung.	Species mapping changes by notification; do not memorise a stale list as current law.
CITES alignment is not automatic incorporation.	2022 Management Authority/Scientific Authority and Chapter VB architecture -> gives domestic machinery for international trade control.	A later CITES decision still needs the applicable Indian legal update.
"Vermin" requires time-sensitive reading.	Old Schedule V was omitted in 2022; Section 62 notification mechanism remains -> avoids treating an old schedule as current law.	Do not retrofit post-2022 law to a historical question such as an older Indian Flying Fox classification.

13.3 Mark-scaled spines

- **10 marks:** state the four schedules, explain Schedule IV and one enforcement institution (WCCB).
- **15/20 marks:** sequence statute -> CITES alignment -> enforcement chain -> invasive-species/rights trade-off; conclude with capacity, not merely a schedule-count claim.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2018-2023.md. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2018-2023 Prelims/CSAT keys are not held locally; no option or answer has been inferred.

- **Years represented:** 2020, 2022
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 2

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2020	Prelims GS-I	81	Schedule VI Wildlife Protection Act plant species implications	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2022	Prelims GS-I	89	Indian wildlife protection laws and protected animal provisions	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Schedule VI Wildlife Protection Act plant species implications
- Indian wildlife protection laws and protected animal provisions

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE SYNTHESIS - SCIENCE-LAW-TRADE AND AUDITED PYQ BOUNDARY

START / CONCEPT: CORE SYNTHESIS - Science-law-trade and audited PYQ boundary

|
v

EXACT TERMS: CORE SYNTHESIS • Science-law-trade • audited PYQ boundary • Mechanism chain • Qualified use • Subject

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer. <!-- END GENERATED PYQ INTEGRATION: 2024-2025.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not infer an objective answer key from a routed PYQ demand.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Mechanism chain: Science, law and trade - Audited PYQ vintage boundary
Qualified use: Close by separating IUCN science, domestic law, CITES trade and PYQ vintage.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Legal vintage first?

A. Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act. B. The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point. C. Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule. D. Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act.

Answer: A. Explanation: Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act. The other options belong to different

ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q2. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Legal vintage first?

A. Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act. B. Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act. C. Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI. D. Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule.

Answer: B. Explanation: Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q3. Which statement uses Legal vintage first without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI. B. Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. C. Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act. D. Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act.

Answer: C. Explanation: Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q4. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Legal vintage first?

A. Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification. B. Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI. C. Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. D. Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act.

Answer: D. Explanation: Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies Six schedules to four?

A. The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point. B. Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act. C. Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI. D. Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q6. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Six schedules to four?

A. Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. B. The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point. C. Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act. D. Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q7. Which statement uses Six schedules to four without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. B. Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI. C. The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point. D. Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q8. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Six schedules to four?

A. The old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022; the owner records a central notification route for a specified area and period and excludes Schedule I animals. B. Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification. C. Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. D. The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Schedule I?

A. Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule. B. Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI. C. Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. D. Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act.

Answer: A. Explanation: Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q10. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Schedule I?

A. Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. B. Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule. C. Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification. D. Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI.

Answer: B. Explanation: Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q11. Which statement uses Schedule I without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. B. Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification. C. Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule. D. The old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022; the owner records a central notification route for a specified area and period and excludes Schedule I animals.

Answer: C. Explanation: Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q12. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Schedule I?

A. The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission. B. Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification. C. The old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022; the owner records a central notification route for a specified area and period and excludes Schedule I animals. D. Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule.

Answer: D. Explanation: Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Schedule II?

A. Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act. B. Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. C. Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification. D. Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI.

Answer: A. Explanation: Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q14. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Schedule II?

A. Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. B. Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act. C. Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification. D. The old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022; the owner records a central notification route for a specified area and period and excludes Schedule I animals.

Answer: B. Explanation: Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q15. Which statement uses Schedule II without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022; the owner records a central notification route for a specified area and period and excludes Schedule I animals. B. The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission. C. Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act. D. Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification.

Answer: C. Explanation: Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q16. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Schedule II?

A. The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission. B. The old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022; the owner records a central notification route for a specified area and period and excludes Schedule I animals. C. Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary. D. Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act.

Answer: D. Explanation: Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Schedule III?

A. Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI. B. Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. C. Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification. D. The old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022; the owner records a central notification route for a specified area and period and excludes Schedule I animals.

Answer: A. Explanation: Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q18. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Schedule III?

A. The old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022; the owner records a central notification route for a specified area and period and excludes Schedule I animals. B. Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI. C. Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification. D. The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission.

Answer: B. Explanation: Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q19. Which statement uses Schedule III without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission. B. The old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022; the owner records a central notification route for a specified area and period and excludes Schedule I animals. C. Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI. D. Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary.

Answer: C. Explanation: Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q20. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Schedule III?

A. The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision. B. Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary. C. The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission. D. Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI.

Answer: D. Explanation: Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Schedule IV?

A. Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. B. The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission. C. Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification. D. The old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022; the owner records a central notification route for a specified area and period and excludes Schedule I animals.

Answer: A. Explanation: Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q22. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Schedule IV?

A. The old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022; the owner records a central notification route for a specified area and period and excludes Schedule I animals. B. Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. C. The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission. D. Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary.

Answer: B. Explanation: Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q23. Which statement uses Schedule IV without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission. B. The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision. C. Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. D. Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary.

Answer: C. Explanation: Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q24. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Schedule IV?

A. The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens. B. The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision. C. Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary. D. Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II.

Answer: D. Explanation: Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Species placement discipline?

A. Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification. B. The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission. C. Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary. D. The old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022; the owner records a central notification route for a specified area and period and excludes Schedule I animals.

Answer: A. Explanation: Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q26. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Species placement discipline?

A. The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission. B. Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification. C. The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision. D. Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary.

Answer: B. Explanation: Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q27. Which statement uses Species placement discipline without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision. B. Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary. C. Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification. D. The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens.

Answer: C. Explanation: Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q28. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Species placement discipline?

A. The Scientific Authority advises on the conservation consequences of trade; it performs a different function from the permit-issuing Management Authority. B. The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision. C. The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens. D. Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification.

Answer: D. Explanation: Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies Vermin time point?

A. The old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022; the owner records a central notification route for a specified area and period and excludes Schedule I animals. B. Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary. C. The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission. D. The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision.

Answer: A. Explanation: The old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022; the owner records a central notification route for a specified area and period and excludes Schedule I animals. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q30. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Vermin time point?

A. Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary. B. The old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022; the owner records a central notification route for a specified area and period and excludes Schedule I animals. C. The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision. D. The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens.

Answer: B. Explanation: The old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022; the owner records a central notification route for a specified area and period and excludes Schedule I animals. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q31. Which statement uses Vermin time point without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens. B. The Scientific Authority advises on the conservation consequences of trade; it performs a different function from the permit-issuing Management Authority. C. The old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022; the owner records a central notification route for a specified area and period and excludes Schedule I animals. D. The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision.

Answer: C. Explanation: The old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022; the owner records a central notification route for a specified area and period and excludes Schedule I animals. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q32. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Vermin time point?

A. The Scientific Authority advises on the conservation consequences of trade; it performs a different function from the permit-issuing Management Authority. B. The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens. C. The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery. D. The old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022; the owner records a central notification route for a specified area and period and excludes Schedule I animals.

Answer: D. Explanation: The old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022; the owner records a central notification route for a specified area and period and excludes Schedule I animals. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Hunting prohibition?

A. The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission. B. Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary. C. The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision. D. The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q34. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Hunting prohibition?

A. The Scientific Authority advises on the conservation consequences of trade; it performs a different function from the permit-issuing Management Authority. B. The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission. C. The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision. D. The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q35. Which statement uses Hunting prohibition without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The Scientific Authority advises on the conservation consequences of trade; it performs a different function from the permit-issuing Management Authority. B. The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery. C. The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission. D. The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q36. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Hunting prohibition?

A. The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery. B. The amendment empowered the Central Government to regulate or prohibit the import, trade, possession or proliferation of invasive alien species under the applicable provision. C. The Scientific Authority advises on the conservation consequences of trade; it performs a different function from the permit-issuing Management Authority. D. The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Permit and exception?

A. Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary. B. The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision. C. The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens. D. The Scientific Authority advises on the conservation consequences of trade; it performs a different function from the permit-issuing Management Authority.

Answer: A. Explanation: Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q38. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Permit and exception?

A. The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery. B. Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary. C. The Scientific Authority advises on the conservation consequences of trade; it performs a different function from the permit-issuing Management Authority. D. The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens.

Answer: B. Explanation: Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q39. Which statement uses Permit and exception without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The Scientific Authority advises on the conservation consequences of trade; it performs a different function from the permit-issuing Management Authority. B. The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery. C. Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary. D. The amendment empowered the Central Government to regulate or prohibit the import, trade, possession or proliferation of invasive alien species under the applicable provision.

Answer: C. Explanation: Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q40. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Permit and exception?

A. The amendment empowered the Central Government to regulate or prohibit the import, trade, possession or proliferation of invasive alien species under the applicable provision. B. The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery. C. MoEFCC's retrievable page states that WCCB was constituted under section 38Y and lists section 38Z functions including intelligence, coordination, capacity and international cooperation. D. Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary.

Answer: D. Explanation: Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Dangerous or beyond recovery route?

A. The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision. B. The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery. C. The Scientific Authority advises on the conservation consequences of trade; it performs a different function from the permit-issuing Management Authority. D. The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q42. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Dangerous or beyond recovery route?

A. The amendment empowered the Central Government to regulate or prohibit the import, trade, possession or proliferation of invasive alien species under the applicable provision. B. The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision. C. The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery. D. The Scientific Authority advises on the conservation consequences of trade; it performs a different function from the permit-issuing Management Authority.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q43. Which statement uses Dangerous or beyond recovery route without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery. B. The amendment empowered the Central Government to regulate or prohibit the import, trade, possession or proliferation of invasive alien species under the applicable provision. C. The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision. D. MoEFCC's retrievable page states that WCCB was constituted under section 38Y and lists section 38Z functions including intelligence, coordination, capacity and international cooperation.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q44. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Dangerous or beyond recovery route?

A. State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB. B. MoEFCC's retrievable page states that WCCB was constituted under section 38Y and lists section 38Z functions including intelligence, coordination, capacity and international cooperation. C. The amendment empowered the Central Government to regulate or prohibit the import, trade, possession or proliferation of invasive alien species under the applicable provision. D. The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies CITES Management Authority?

A. The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens. B. The Scientific Authority advises on the conservation consequences of trade; it performs a different function from the permit-issuing Management Authority. C. The amendment empowered the Central Government to regulate or prohibit the import, trade, possession or proliferation of invasive alien species under the applicable provision. D. The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery.

Answer: A. Explanation: The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q46. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of CITES Management Authority?

A. The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery. B. The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens. C. MoEFCC's retrievable page states that WCCB was constituted under section 38Y and lists section 38Z functions including intelligence, coordination, capacity and international cooperation. D. The amendment empowered the Central Government to regulate or prohibit the import, trade, possession or proliferation of invasive alien species under the applicable provision.

Answer: B. Explanation: The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q47. Which statement uses CITES Management Authority without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The amendment empowered the Central Government to regulate or prohibit the import, trade, possession or proliferation of invasive alien species under the applicable provision. B. State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB. C. The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens. D. MoEFCC's retrievable page states that WCCB was constituted under section 38Y and lists section 38Z functions including intelligence, coordination, capacity and international cooperation.

Answer: C. Explanation: The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q48. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about CITES Management Authority?

A. MoEFCC's retrievable page states that WCCB was constituted under section 38Y and lists section 38Z functions including intelligence, coordination, capacity and international cooperation. B. NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities. C. State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB. D. The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens.

Answer: D. Explanation: The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies CITES Scientific Authority?

A. The Scientific Authority advises on the conservation consequences of trade; it performs a different function from the permit-issuing Management Authority. B. The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery. C. The amendment empowered the Central Government to regulate or prohibit the import, trade, possession or proliferation of invasive alien species under the applicable provision. D. MoEFCC's retrievable page states that WCCB was constituted under section 38Y and lists section 38Z functions including intelligence, coordination, capacity and international cooperation.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Scientific Authority advises on the conservation consequences of trade; it performs a different function from the permit-issuing Management Authority. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q50. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of CITES Scientific Authority?

A. MoEFCC's retrievable page states that WCCB was constituted under section 38Y and lists section 38Z functions including intelligence, coordination, capacity and international cooperation. B. The Scientific Authority advises on the conservation consequences of trade; it performs a different function from the permit-issuing Management Authority. C. State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB. D. The amendment empowered the Central Government to regulate or prohibit the import, trade, possession or proliferation of invasive alien species under the applicable provision.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Scientific Authority advises on the conservation consequences of trade; it performs a different function from the permit-issuing Management Authority. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q51. Which statement uses CITES Scientific Authority without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB. B. MoEFCC's retrievable page states that WCCB was constituted under section 38Y and lists section 38Z functions including intelligence, coordination, capacity and international cooperation. C. The Scientific Authority advises on the conservation consequences of trade; it performs a different function from the permit-issuing Management Authority. D. NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Scientific Authority advises on the conservation consequences of trade; it performs a different function from the permit-issuing Management Authority. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q52. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about CITES Scientific Authority?

A. IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct. B. NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities. C. State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB. D. The Scientific Authority advises on the conservation consequences of trade; it performs a different function from the permit-issuing Management Authority.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Scientific Authority advises on the conservation consequences of trade; it performs a different function from the permit-issuing Management Authority. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies Chapter VB trade architecture?

A. The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery. B. The amendment empowered the Central Government to regulate or prohibit the import, trade, possession or proliferation of invasive alien species under the applicable provision. C. State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB. D. MoEFCC's retrievable page states that WCCB was constituted under section 38Y and lists section 38Z functions including intelligence, coordination, capacity and international cooperation.

Answer: A. Explanation: The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q54. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Chapter VB trade architecture?

A. NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities. B. The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery. C. State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB. D. MoEFCC's retrievable page states that WCCB was constituted under section 38Y and lists section 38Z functions including intelligence, coordination, capacity and international cooperation.

Answer: B. Explanation: The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q55. Which statement uses Chapter VB trade architecture without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB. B. IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct. C. The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery. D. NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities.

Answer: C. Explanation: The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q56. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Chapter VB trade architecture?

A. NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities. B. IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct. C. Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key. D. The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery.

Answer: D. Explanation: The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Invasive alien species?

A. The amendment empowered the Central Government to regulate or prohibit the import, trade, possession or proliferation of invasive alien species under the applicable provision. B. State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB. C. NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities. D. MoEFCC's retrievable page states that WCCB was constituted under section 38Y and lists section 38Z functions including intelligence, coordination, capacity and international cooperation.

Answer: A. Explanation: The amendment empowered the Central Government to regulate or prohibit the import, trade, possession or proliferation of invasive alien species under the applicable provision. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q58. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Invasive alien species?

A. State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB. B. The amendment empowered the Central Government to regulate or prohibit the import, trade, possession or proliferation of invasive alien species under the applicable provision. C. IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct. D. NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities.

Answer: B. Explanation: The amendment empowered the Central Government to regulate or prohibit the import, trade, possession or proliferation of invasive alien species under the applicable provision. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q59. Which statement uses Invasive alien species without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key. B. NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities. C. The amendment empowered the Central Government to regulate or prohibit the import, trade, possession or proliferation of invasive alien species under the applicable provision. D. IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct.

Answer: C. Explanation: The amendment empowered the Central Government to regulate or prohibit the import, trade, possession or proliferation of invasive alien species under the applicable provision. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q60. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Invasive alien species?

A. Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key. B. IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct. C. Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act. D. The amendment empowered the Central Government to regulate or prohibit the import, trade, possession or proliferation of invasive alien species under the applicable provision.

Answer: D. Explanation: The amendment empowered the Central Government to regulate or prohibit the import, trade, possession or proliferation of invasive alien species under the applicable provision. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies WCCB statutory role?

A. MoEFCC's retrievable page states that WCCB was constituted under section 38Y and lists section 38Z functions including intelligence, coordination, capacity and international cooperation. B. State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB. C. IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct. D. NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities.

Answer: A. Explanation: MoEFCC's retrievable page states that WCCB was constituted under section 38Y and lists section 38Z functions including intelligence, coordination, capacity and international cooperation. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q62. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of WCCB statutory role?

A. IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct. B. MoEFCC's retrievable page states that WCCB was constituted under section 38Y and lists section 38Z functions including intelligence, coordination, capacity and international cooperation. C. NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities. D. Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key.

Answer: B. Explanation: MoEFCC's retrievable page states that WCCB was constituted under section 38Y and lists section 38Z functions including intelligence, coordination, capacity and international cooperation. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q63. Which statement uses WCCB statutory role without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act. B. Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key. C. MoEFCC's retrievable page states that WCCB was constituted under section 38Y and lists section 38Z functions including intelligence, coordination, capacity and international cooperation. D. IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct.

Answer: C. Explanation: MoEFCC's retrievable page states that WCCB was constituted under section 38Y and lists section 38Z functions including intelligence, coordination, capacity and international cooperation. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q64. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about WCCB statutory role?

A. Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key. B. Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act. C. The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point. D. MoEFCC's retrievable page states that WCCB was constituted under section 38Y and lists section 38Z functions including intelligence, coordination, capacity and international cooperation.

Answer: D. Explanation: MoEFCC's retrievable page states that WCCB was constituted under section 38Y and lists section 38Z functions including intelligence, coordination, capacity and international cooperation. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies State and Chief Wildlife Warden?

A. State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB. B. NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities. C. Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key. D. IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct.

Answer: A. Explanation: State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q66. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of State and Chief Wildlife Warden?

A. Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act. B. State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB. C. IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct. D. Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key.

Answer: B. Explanation: State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q67. Which statement uses State and Chief Wildlife Warden without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point. B. Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act. C. State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB. D. Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key.

Answer: C. Explanation: State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q68. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about State and Chief Wildlife Warden?

A. Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule. B. The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point. C. Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act. D. State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB.

Answer: D. Explanation: State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies NBWL and NTCA?

A. NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities. B. Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key. C. Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act. D. IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct.

Answer: A. Explanation: NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q70. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of NBWL and NTCA?

A. Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key. B. NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities. C. The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point. D. Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act.

Answer: B. Explanation: NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q71. Which statement uses NBWL and NTCA without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act. B. The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point. C. NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities. D. Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule.

Answer: C. Explanation: NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q72. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about NBWL and NTCA?

A. Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule. B. Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act. C. The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point. D. NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities.

Answer: D. Explanation: NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Science, law and trade?

A. IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct. B. The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point. C. Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key. D. Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act.

Answer: A. Explanation: IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q74. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Science, law and trade?

A. Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act. B. IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct. C. The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point. D. Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule.

Answer: B. Explanation: IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q75. Which statement uses Science, law and trade without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point. B. Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule. C. IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct. D. Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act.

Answer: C. Explanation: IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q76. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Science, law and trade?

A. Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI. B. Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule. C. Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act. D. IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct.

Answer: D. Explanation: IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Audited PYQ vintage boundary?

A. Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key. B. The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point. C. Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act. D. Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule.

Answer: A. Explanation: Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q78. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Audited PYQ vintage boundary?

A. The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point. B. Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key. C. Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule. D. Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act.

Answer: B. Explanation: Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q79. Which statement uses Audited PYQ vintage boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI. B. Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act. C. Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key. D. Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule.

Answer: C. Explanation: Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q80. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Audited PYQ vintage boundary?

A. Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act. B. Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI. C. Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. D. Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key.

Answer: D. Explanation: Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED OBJECTIVE-ONLY PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT

Audited ledgers route the 2020 old Schedule VI plant demand, 2022 protected-animal provisions and 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin framing. They remain answer-free objective demands. The package fixes the legal time point and does not infer a species placement, penalty, notification or option key.

OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

9. PYQ application

- ANALYSIS: Recurring Prelims pattern: identify the correct number of schedules post-2022 and match the CITES-alignment feature to Schedule IV specifically.
- ANALYSIS: Mains linkage: the domestic-law-to-international-obligation alignment (Schedule IV/ CITES) is used to argue for coherent, enforceable wildlife-trade governance.

Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

Status: 2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2024-2025.md. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2024-2025 Prelims Set-A keys are present in the repository and CSAT Set-A keys are supplied; even so, no option or answer is recorded or inferred in this integration.

- **Years represented:** 2024
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2024	Prelims GS-I	20	Indian Flying Fox 'vermin' category under the Wild Life (Protection) Act, 1972	Objective question; official Set-A key available locally, answer not inferred	Key available locally (official Set-A answer key present); answer not recorded here	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Indian Flying Fox 'vermin' category under the Wild Life (Protection) Act, 1972

This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2018-2023.md. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2018-2023 Prelims/CSAT keys are not held locally; no option or answer has been inferred.

- **Years represented:** 2020, 2022
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 2

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2020	Prelims GS-I	81	Schedule VI Wildlife Protection Act plant species implications	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2022	Prelims GS-I	89	Indian wildlife protection laws and protected animal provisions	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Schedule VI Wildlife Protection Act plant species implications
- Indian wildlife protection laws and protected animal provisions

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- ANALYSIS: Prelims statement-based questions on the 2022 amendment typically test the schedule-count change and the CITES-alignment feature - apply the "four schedules, Schedule IV mirrors CITES" rule to eliminate incorrect options quickly.
- ANALYSIS: Mains answers should connect the 2022 amendment explicitly to India's CITES compliance narrative (Topic 09) and to enforcement-capacity critique, rather than describing it as an isolated domestic legal change.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Explain the post-2022 four-schedule structure. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Legal vintage first. **Named evidence/example:** Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Six schedules to four. **Named evidence/example:** The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Schedule I.

Named evidence/example: Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Schedule II.

Named evidence/example: Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Schedule III. **Named evidence/example:** Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI.

Analysis: This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim: Schedule IV. **Named evidence/example:** Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act.
- The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point.
- Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule.

- Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act.
- Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI.
- Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Legal vintage first. **Named evidence/example:** Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act.

Analysis: This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim: Six schedules to four. **Named evidence/example:** The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Schedule I.

Named evidence/example: Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Schedule II.

Named evidence/example: Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim: Schedule III. **Named evidence/example:** Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Schedule IV. **Named evidence/example:** Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Schedule IV. **Named evidence/example:** Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Distinguish Schedule IV trade control from animal protection tiers. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Schedule I. **Named evidence/example:** Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Schedule II. **Named evidence/example:** Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Schedule IV. **Named evidence/example:** Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and

evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Science, law and trade. **Named evidence/example:** IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule.
- Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act.
- Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II.
- IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Schedule I. **Named evidence/example:** Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Schedule II. **Named evidence/example:** Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Schedule IV. **Named evidence/example:** Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Science, law and trade. **Named evidence/example:** IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Explain hunting prohibition and narrow statutory exceptions. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Hunting prohibition. **Named evidence/example:** The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Permit and exception. **Named evidence/example:** Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Dangerous or beyond recovery route. **Named evidence/example:** The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and

causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** State and Chief Wildlife Warden. **Named evidence/example:** State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission.
- Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary.
- The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision.
- State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Hunting prohibition. **Named evidence/example:** The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Permit and exception. **Named evidence/example:** Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary.

Analysis: This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim: Dangerous or beyond recovery route. **Named evidence/example:** The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** State and Chief Wildlife Warden. **Named evidence/example:** State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Explain CITES alignment through Schedule IV and the two authorities. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** Schedule IV. **Named evidence/example:** Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II.

Analysis: This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim: CITES Management Authority. **Named evidence/example:** The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** CITES

Scientific Authority. **Named evidence/example:** The Scientific Authority advises on the conservation consequences of trade; it performs a different function from the permit-issuing Management Authority. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Chapter VB trade architecture. **Named evidence/example:** The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II.
- The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens.
- The Scientific Authority advises on the conservation consequences of trade; it performs a different function from the permit-issuing Management Authority.
- The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Schedule IV. **Named evidence/example:** Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II.

Analysis: This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim: CITES Management Authority. **Named evidence/example:** The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** CITES

Scientific Authority. **Named evidence/example:** The Scientific Authority advises on the conservation consequences of trade; it performs a different function from the permit-issuing Management Authority. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Chapter VB trade architecture. **Named evidence/example:** The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Assess the 2022 amendment as treaty-alignment and enforcement reform. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Six schedules to four. **Named evidence/example:** The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point.

Analysis: This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim: Species placement discipline. **Named evidence/example:** Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification.

Analysis: This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial

scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim: Chapter VB trade architecture. **Named evidence/example:** The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery.

Analysis: This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim: Invasive alien species. **Named evidence/example:** The amendment empowered the Central Government to regulate or prohibit the import, trade, possession or proliferation of invasive alien species under the applicable provision. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim: WCCB statutory role. **Named evidence/example:** MoEFCC's retrievable page states that WCCB was constituted under section 38Y and lists section 38Z functions including intelligence, coordination, capacity and international cooperation. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** NBWL and NTCA. **Named evidence/example:** NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point.
- Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification.
- The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery.
- The amendment empowered the Central Government to regulate or prohibit the import, trade, possession or proliferation of invasive alien species under the applicable provision.
- MoEFCC's retrievable page states that WCCB was constituted under section 38Y and lists section 38Z functions including intelligence, coordination, capacity and international cooperation.
- NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Six schedules to four. **Named evidence/example:** The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim: Species placement discipline. **Named evidence/example:** Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification.

Analysis: This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim: Chapter VB trade architecture. **Named evidence/example:** The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery.

Analysis: This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

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ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Why must wildlife-law answers be time-sensitive and jurisdiction-specific? Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** Legal vintage first. **Named evidence/example:** Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Species placement discipline. **Named evidence/example:** Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Vermin time point. **Named evidence/example:** The old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022; the owner records a central notification route for a specified area and period and excludes Schedule I animals. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** State and Chief Wildlife Warden. **Named evidence/example:** State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Science, law and trade. **Named evidence/example:** IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Audited PYQ vintage boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act.

- Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification.
- The old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022; the owner records a central notification route for a specified area and period and excludes Schedule I animals.
- State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB.
- IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct.
- Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Legal vintage first. **Named evidence/example:** Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act.

Analysis: This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim: Species placement discipline. **Named evidence/example:** Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification.

Analysis: This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim: Vermin time point. **Named evidence/example:** The old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022; the owner records a central notification route for a specified area and period and excludes Schedule I animals. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** State and Chief Wildlife Warden. **Named evidence/example:** State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

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OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

Subject: Environment and Ecology | **Tier:** Advanced | **GS Paper:** GS-III (Environment) + Prelims, with GS-II legal/governance linkage. **Core area:** Domestic wildlife law architecture. **Grounded in:** Wildlife (Protection) Amendment Act, 2022 (India Code); PRS Legislative Research bill analysis; MoEFCC notifications; audited UPSC Environment PYQs (2024-2026 Prelims and 2024-2025 Mains). **FACT:** = source-grounded | **ANALYSIS:** = inference/analysis | **CURRENT:** = dated current-affairs anchor. *Companion:* basic/08_Wildlife-Protection-Act-and-Schedules.md.

1. Why the 2022 amendment is a treaty-compliance statute, not merely a tidy-up

ANALYSIS: The restructuring from six schedules to four was not primarily a simplification exercise - its central legal-policy driver was closing gaps flagged in India's CITES compliance (bringing domestic schedules into direct correspondence with CITES Appendices I/II/III via the new Schedule IV) and empowering more effective enforcement against wildlife trafficking, which had been identified as a persistent gap between India's international commitments and its enforceable domestic provisions. Mains answers should present the 2022 amendment as a compliance-and-enforcement reform, not just a schedule count reduction.

2. Key substantive changes introduced by the 2022 amendment

Change	Legal/governance significance
FACT: Schedule restructuring (6 -> 4): Schedules I and II for animals , Schedule III for plants (formerly Schedule VI), Schedule IV for CITES-listed scheduled specimens ; the old Schedule V (vermin) omitted	Directly operationalises CITES Appendix listings in domestic law, closing the enforcement gap where a CITES-listed species lacked an exact domestic equivalent - and removes a standing statutory vermin list that had drawn criticism for enabling blanket culling declarations.
FACT: New chapter on regulation of international trade in scheduled specimens , with statutory designation of a Management Authority and a Scientific Authority	Gives India the exact two-authority institutional architecture CITES requires of every Party, moving the designation from administrative practice to statute (Topic 09).
FACT: Central government empowered to regulate/manage invasive alien species	Extends wildlife law beyond native-species protection to proactive control of ecologically damaging introduced species - a notable conceptual widening of the Act's scope.
FACT: Statutory backing for management plans for sanctuaries and national parks	Strengthens the administrative backbone of the protected-area network (Topic 06) by making the plan, rather than ad hoc administrative decision, the operative instrument.
FACT: Provision for voluntary surrender of captive animals/derivatives to the Chief Wildlife Warden, which then vest in the government	A pragmatic amnesty-style route to bring undeclared holdings into the legal system rather than driving them underground.
ANALYSIS: Strengthened penalty and enforcement framework, intended to support international cooperation on trafficking	Aims to improve India's standing and effectiveness in CITES-related enforcement cooperation, though outcomes depend on state-level implementation capacity.

3. The CITES-alignment mechanism in legal-technical detail

1. FACT: Schedule IV under the amended Act is structured with parts corresponding to CITES Appendices I, II and III, meaning a species newly added to a CITES Appendix (via CITES Conference of Parties decisions) can, in principle, be reflected in Indian domestic law through a corresponding Schedule IV update rather than requiring an entirely separate domestic classification exercise.
2. ANALYSIS: **Analytical caution:** this "mirroring" is a structural alignment mechanism, not an automatic, instantaneous incorporation - actual domestic legal effect still requires the relevant Indian notification process to update Schedule IV following a CITES Appendix change; the two processes are linked in design but not procedurally instantaneous.
3. ANALYSIS: This is the concrete answer to why India's 2022 amendment is frequently cited in the same breath as CITES (Topic 09) - the reform exists specifically to make Indian law's species classification legible and directly comparable to CITES' international trade- regulation categories.

4. Enforcement architecture and implementation gaps

- FACT: **Wildlife Crime Control Bureau (WCCB):** coordinates intelligence, investigation support and international liaison (e.g., with INTERPOL environmental-crime mechanisms) on organised wildlife trafficking.
- ANALYSIS: **Implementation gap:** wildlife-crime prosecution in India has faced documented challenges including low conviction rates, capacity constraints in forensic wildlife identification (species/part identification for prosecution), and jurisdictional coordination difficulties across state forest departments, police and customs when trafficking crosses state or international borders.

- ANALYSIS: Invasive-alien-species regulation is a newly empowered but still maturing governance area - identifying, listing and effectively controlling invasive species (which may already be economically entrenched, e.g., certain ornamental or agricultural species) involves a genuine trade-off between ecological risk management and existing economic use, a nuance Mains answers should acknowledge rather than treating invasive-species control as administratively simple.

5. Data and conceptual limitations

- ANALYSIS: Comprehensive, real-time national data on wildlife-crime prosecution outcomes (conviction rates, case backlogs) is not centrally published in a single standardised dataset; analytical claims about enforcement effectiveness should be qualified as indicative rather than precisely quantified unless a specific WCCB/NCRB report is cited.

- ANALYSIS: The exact, current species-to-Schedule mapping is subject to periodic gazette notification and is not static - any specific species-Schedule claim beyond well-established flagship examples (tiger, elephant in Schedule I) should be verified against the latest MoEFCC notification before being treated as settled fact.

6. Recurring UPSC analytical tensions

Tension	Balanced framing
Legal alignment with CITES vs actual enforcement capacity	Structural alignment (Schedule IV) is necessary but must be matched with forensic, prosecutorial and cross-border coordination capacity to translate into real deterrence.
Native-species protection focus vs invasive-species control mandate	The 2022 amendment's invasive-species provision reflects a maturing, ecosystem-level (not just single-species) view of wildlife law, but implementation must weigh existing economic dependencies.
Central Schedule-setting vs state-level enforcement variability	Uniform national Schedules do not guarantee uniform state-level enforcement outcomes - capacity-building remains state-dependent.

7. Must-Know Facts for Advanced Prelims

- FACT: The Wildlife (Protection) Amendment Act, 2022 restructured six schedules into four and introduced a CITES Appendix-mirroring Schedule IV.
- FACT: Post-2022 schedule content: I and II = animals (greater/lesser protection), III = plants, IV = CITES scheduled specimens; the vermin schedule was **omitted**.
- FACT: The 2022 amendment empowered the central government to regulate/manage invasive alien species - a scope extension beyond native-species protection.
- FACT: The amendment gave **statutory** footing to India's CITES **Management Authority** and **Scientific Authority**, and to **management plans** for sanctuaries and national parks.
- FACT: The Wildlife Crime Control Bureau (WCCB) coordinates intelligence and enforcement against organised wildlife trafficking, including international liaison.
- FACT: Schedule IV's CITES-mirroring structure is a legal-alignment mechanism, not an automatic, instantaneous incorporation of every CITES Appendix change.

8. Advanced Prelims traps

- WRONG: CITES Appendix changes automatically and instantly amend India's Schedule IV without any domestic notification process. -> Domestic legal effect still requires an Indian notification updating Schedule IV following a CITES Appendix change.
- WRONG: The invasive-alien-species provision under the 2022 amendment applies only to plants. -> It is designed to cover invasive species broadly, extending the Act's ecosystem-level scope.
- WRONG: Wildlife-crime enforcement challenges in India are purely a legal-drafting problem. ->

Documented challenges include forensic capacity, prosecutorial resources and cross- jurisdictional coordination, not only statutory text.

- WRONG: All Indian states have uniformly strong wildlife-crime enforcement capacity. -> Capacity varies significantly by state, despite uniform national Schedule classification.

9. CURRENT: Current anchor - analytical use

Verified current anchor	Topic-specific analytical use
CURRENT: Wildlife (Protection) Amendment Act, 2022 - current governing legal structure (4 schedules, CITES-mirroring Schedule IV, invasive-species provision).	Use as the baseline legal framework for any question on India's wildlife-trade law; verify any subsequent notification/amendment before citing further updates.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- ANALYSIS: Prelims statement-based questions on the 2022 amendment typically test the schedule-count change and the CITES-alignment feature - apply the "four schedules, Schedule IV mirrors CITES" rule to eliminate incorrect options quickly.

- ANALYSIS: Mains answers should connect the 2022 amendment explicitly to India's CITES compliance narrative (Topic 09) and to enforcement-capacity critique, rather than describing it as an isolated domestic legal change.

11. Mains-ready framework

Central thesis: The Wildlife (Protection) Amendment Act, 2022 is best understood as a treaty-compliance and enforcement reform - restructuring domestic Schedules to mirror CITES Appendices and widening the Act's scope to invasive species - but its real conservation impact depends on closing the enforcement-capacity gap (forensic, prosecutorial, cross- jurisdictional) that has historically limited Indian wildlife-crime deterrence.

1. State the 2022 amendment's structural changes (four schedules, CITES-mirroring Schedule IV, invasive-species empowerment).
2. Explain the CITES-alignment mechanism precisely, including that it requires a domestic notification step, not automatic incorporation.
3. Identify the enforcement-architecture bodies (WCCB, state departments) and their documented capacity constraints.
4. Flag the invasive-species economic-use trade-off as a genuine implementation nuance.
5. Conclude with a capacity-building, not just legal-restructuring, recommendation.

12. Probable questions

- ANALYSIS: **Prelims:** Identify correct statements on the number of schedules and the CITES-mirroring feature introduced by the 2022 amendment.
- ANALYSIS: **Mains (10 marks):** How does Schedule IV of the amended Wildlife Protection Act align with CITES Appendices, and what are the limits of this alignment mechanism?
- ANALYSIS: **Mains (15 marks):** Critically evaluate whether the Wildlife (Protection) Amendment Act, 2022 has meaningfully strengthened India's enforcement capacity against wildlife trafficking.

13. Study links

- FACT: Foundation companion: basic/08_Wildlife-Protection-Act-and-Schedules.md.
- FACT: 09_CITES-and-Wildlife-Trade.md - the international treaty this reform aligns with.
- FACT: 06_Protected-Area-Network-India.md - protected-area provisions strengthened by the same amendment.
- FACT: 27_Environmental-Institutions-MoEFCC-CPCB-NBA-WII.md - WCCB's full institutional mandate.

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

Wildlife Protection Act and Schedules: LEGAL VINTAGE, SCHEDULE AND AUTHORITY MAP

1. **Legal vintage first:** Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act.
2. **Six schedules to four:** The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point.
3. **Schedule I:** Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule.
4. **Schedule II:** Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act.
5. **Schedule III:** Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI.
6. **Schedule IV:** Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II.
7. **Species placement discipline:** Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification.
8. **Vermin time point:** The old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022; the owner records a central notification route for a specified area and period and excludes Schedule I animals.
9. **Hunting prohibition:** The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission.
10. **Permit and exception:** Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary.
11. **Dangerous or beyond recovery route:** The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision.
12. **CITES Management Authority:** The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens.
13. **CITES Scientific Authority:** The Scientific Authority advises on the conservation consequences of trade; it performs a different function from the permit-issuing Management Authority.
14. **Chapter VB trade architecture:** The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery.
15. **Invasive alien species:** The amendment empowered the Central Government to regulate or prohibit the import, trade, possession or proliferation of invasive alien species under the applicable provision.
16. **WCCB statutory role:** MoEFCC's retrievable page states that WCCB was constituted under section 38Y and lists section 38Z functions including intelligence, coordination, capacity and international cooperation.
17. **State and Chief Wildlife Warden:** State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB.
18. **NBWL and NTCA:** NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities.
19. **Science, law and trade:** IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct.
20. **Audited PYQ vintage boundary:** Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key.

Wildlife Protection Act and Schedules: PROHIBITION, EXCEPTION, VERMIN AND TRADE TRAPS

- Do not answer a pre-2022 question with the post-2022 schedule count without qualification.
- Do not say the current Act still has six schedules.
- Do not assign a species to Schedule I from memory without checking the current text.
- Do not describe Schedule II as unprotected wildlife.
- Do not call post-2022 Schedule III an animal-protection tier.
- Do not call Schedule IV the highest domestic protection category.
- Do not treat CITES Appendix change as an instantaneous Indian schedule amendment.
- Do not say the old Schedule V vermin list still exists.
- Do not convert a hunting exception into a general permission.
- Do not omit the competent authority and written-permission requirement.
- Do not merge Management Authority and Scientific Authority functions.
- Do not use WCCB as the authority for every wildlife-law decision.
- Do not attach a penalty amount without the applicable amendment and offence provision.
- Do not equate an IUCN category, domestic schedule and CITES Appendix.
- Do not infer an objective answer key from a routed PYQ demand.

Wildlife Protection Act and Schedules: STATUTE-TO-ENFORCEMENT ANSWER SPINE

FIX THE LEGAL TIME POINT: PRE-2022 OR POST-2022

- > STATE THE FUNCTION OF SCHEDULE I, II, III OR IV
- > VERIFY THE SPECIES PLACEMENT OR NOTIFICATION
- > START WITH PROHIBITION, THEN TEST THE NARROW EXCEPTION
- > NAME THE COMPETENT AUTHORITY, PERMIT AND JURISDICTION
- > SEPARATE IUCN SCIENCE, DOMESTIC LAW AND CITES TRADE
- > CONCLUDE WITH FORENSICS, COORDINATION AND ENFORCEMENT CAPACITY

Wildlife Protection Act and Schedules: LIVE STATUTE, NOTIFICATION, PENALTY AND SPECIES-PLACEMENT BOUNDARY

India Code returned HTTP 403 on 2026-09-03. Official state forest department copies of the 2022 amendment were retrievable only as raw or image PDF bytes and were not text-mined. MoEFCC's wildlife page was used narrowly for WCCB sections 38Y and 38Z; its stale or erroneous material was excluded. No species schedule, penalty or later amendment was inferred.

COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM

High-yield use: Follow the panels as one topic-specific conceptual atlas: root question, classifications, processes or arguments, comparisons, objections and a final answer-writing spine. This text-native master is separate from both graphical flowchart artifacts.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 1/12: Legal-vintage timeline

1972 ACT -> original wildlife-protection framework
PRE-2022 -> six schedules
2022 AMENDMENT -> restructuring
POST-2022 -> four schedules
RULE -> answer the law applicable to the question's time point

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 2/12: Post-2022 schedule map

SCHEDULE I -> animals, greatest degree of protection
SCHEDULE II -> animals, lesser degree than Schedule I
SCHEDULE III -> specified plants
SCHEDULE IV -> CITES scheduled specimens and trade control
RULE -> Schedule IV is not another protection rung

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 3/12: Species-placement gate

NAME A SPECIES -> identify legal date
CHECK -> current consolidated schedule or notification
IUCN STATUS -> separate scientific field
CITES APPENDIX -> separate trade field
NO MEMORY SHORTCUT -> placement can change

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 4/12: Vermin time-point map

OLD STRUCTURE -> Schedule V vermin list
2022 CHANGE -> old Schedule V omitted
CURRENT OWNER ROUTE -> central notification
LIMITS -> specified area and period; Schedule I excluded
PYQ RULE -> use the law in force when the question is framed

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 5/12: Prohibition and exception gate

BASELINE -> hunting prohibited
CLAIMED EXCEPTION -> identify statutory purpose or condition
AUTHORITY -> Chief Wildlife Warden or other authorised officer
FORM -> applicable written permission or permit
RULE -> exception never becomes general permission

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 6/12: Narrow animal-action route

DANGEROUS TO HUMAN LIFE -> test statutory condition
DISABLED OR DISEASED BEYOND RECOVERY -> test evidence
SCHEDULE -> determines applicable authority route
WRITTEN PERMISSION -> retain in the answer
NO EXTENSION -> do not invent a population-control exception

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 7/12: CITES authority split

MANAGEMENT AUTHORITY -> permits and certificates
SCIENTIFIC AUTHORITY -> conservation advice on trade
CHAPTER VB -> domestic international-trade machinery
SCHEDULE IV -> scheduled specimens
RULE -> advice, permission and species listing are separate functions

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 8/12: CITES incorporation firewall

CITES COP OR APPENDIX -> international decision
INDIAN LEGAL PROCESS -> applicable domestic update
SCHEDULE IV -> domestic scheduled-specimen status
PERMIT SYSTEM -> Management Authority action
NO AUTOMATICITY -> international change is not instant domestic text

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 9/12: Invasive alien species power

IDENTIFY -> species claimed to be invasive
VERIFY -> applicable legal notification or order
CENTRAL POWER -> regulate or prohibit listed activities
IMPLEMENT -> trade, possession and proliferation controls as applicable
CAUTION -> no species list is inferred from the enabling power

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 10/12: WCCB statutory map

SECTION 38Y -> constitution of WCCB on MoEFCC page
SECTION 38Z -> functions on MoEFCC page
INTELLIGENCE -> collection, collation and dissemination
COORDINATION -> enforcement and international cooperation
LIMIT -> WCCB does not replace every statutory decision-maker

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 11/12: Domestic authority matrix

CHIEF WILDLIFE WARDEN -> state authorisation and enforcement route
WCCB -> organised wildlife-crime intelligence and coordination
NBWL -> protected-area governance role
NTCA -> tiger-specific statutory role
CITES AUTHORITIES -> international scheduled-specimen trade

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 12/12: PYQ and answer spine

DATE -> pre-2022 or post-2022 structure
CLASSIFY -> Schedule I, II, III or IV function
TRACE -> prohibition, exception, authority and permit
SEPARATE -> IUCN risk, domestic schedule and CITES trade
QUALIFY -> verify current placement, penalty and objective key